LFH Case No. 061

Shopiere[1] Apr.9th/72

Friend Etta,

I have been waiting impatiently for the time to come when I should be well enough to answer your letter. Mother made me go to bed the day after I came home and I stayed there for a long time it seems to me. But I am up now and have been out in the garden two or three times. I was very much disapointed for I expected to be well in a few days after I got home. My good brother Doctor has given me two large bottles of medicine besides powders and pills, but I find I'm not to be cured so easily as I thought I feel very thankful for such good parents, sisters, brothers, and friends. it seems as if everyone is good to me and I know I dont deserve it. They gave me apples, nuts, candy, oranges, lemons, figs and lots of nice things when I was sick. to say nothing of the nice soups and puddings. I never can repay them for doing so much for me, nor you for taking such good care of me when I was sick up to Milton. I think of it every day, and then I come home without ever thanking you for it. Frans[2] was saying the other day, she would have to send you a note of thanks for taking such good care of her sister. She is up to see Mother Swingle's now and I miss her so much. I received my clothes all right and and am very much obliged to you for doing them up so nicely. but I am real sorry it happened so for I would'nt have put you to all that trouble for anything I think they must have been quite an addition to the load which the horses had to draw, not on account of the weight of the clothes themselves, but of the large amount of Milton soil that was on them. I dont know whether Jennie has written to you or not. She and all of her folks have been sick with the Measles but I guess they are better now. Have you been so fortunate as to escape them? Clara Van Valen has also had them, and my brother Charlie is just getting over them, we thought he had had them before but I never heard of anyone having them twice. I am glad you are enjoying yourself so well visiting. I would like ever so much to have you come and stay a week or so with me before you commence teaching. Mother wants to see you, I've spoken of you so often. If you can, please let me know when you can come so I will be

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1. Shopiere, Wisconsin, is located in southeast Rock County.
2. "Frans" could be "Franks." Perhaps a nickname for "Francis."

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sure to be at home, for as soon as I get better I want to make a few visits around here, and I want to be home when you come. But I am afraid I will tire you. I am not in the mood for writing letters today and so cannot write a very interesting one. but I wanted you to know that we received our clothes all right, and I thank you for my apple. I want to make a clove apple of it if I can and keep it to remember your home by. Give my love to your mother,

Please write soon

I'd like it if some muse Emma,

would come and tell me what to say but well I know he never will

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LFH Case No. 061 9 April 1872 Letter Emma Jane Thayer[3], Shopiere, Wisconsin to Juliette A. E. Flagler, Milton, Wisconsin. Data: 1 letter sheet; 1 letter written; Author's sex F; 1 author; author's age 99; No env.; Cursive; Pencil and Black ink; Embossed with a female "liberty" head side profile facing left in ulhc; blue-lined; No watermark; No letterhead; Complimentary close; No separate signature line; Postscript reads: "I'd like it if some muse would come and tell me what to say but well I know he never will"; Thayer; Written Tuesday; TOD unknown; Spring; 12.4 x 20.2 cm (5 x 8 in); 1 date; Doc. cond. good; Legibility fair; cotton-fibre; Nwotim; No crossing Letters; Heading; Per. informal greeting.

There are eight letters written by Emma J. Thayer to Juliette A. E. Flagler.[4] Emma begins her missive to Ettie stating that she has been waiting impatiently until she is well enough to answer Ettie's letter. Emma states that her mother, Elizabeth Thayer, made Emma go to bed and stay there "for a long time." She adds that she is up now and have been out to the garden but was disappointed she had to convalesce for so long. She adds that her "good brother Doctor" had given her "two large bottles of medicine besides powders and pills, but I find I'm not to be cured so easily as I thought." Emma feels very grateful for her parents, sisters and brothers and friends for aiding her recovery and feels she doesn't deserve it. She was given "apples, nuts, candy, oranges, lemons, figs and lots of nice things when I was sick. to say nothing of the nice soups and puddings." Emma feels that she could never "repay them for doing so much for me" nor for Ettie for taking such good care of Emma when she was sick in Milton. She adds that Frans was saying she would have to send a note of thanks to Ettie for such good care of her sister. Emma thanks Ettie for sending her clothes to her and adds that it must have been "quite an addition to the load which the horses had to draw, not on account of the weight of the clothes themselves, but of the large amount of Milton soil that was on them." She mentions a mutual friend Jennie and the fact that "She and all of her folks have been sick with the Measles but I guess they are better now. Have you been so fortunate as to escape them?" Emma writes that Clara Van Valen has the measles and also Emma's brother Charlie who is "getting over them." Emma then asks if Ettie could visit with Emma for a week before she commences "teaching" and that her mother wants to see Ettie as well. Emma asks Ettie to write her if she plans on coming so that she will be sure to "be home for as soon as I get better I want to make a few visits around here, and I want to be home when you come." Emma writes she is afraid she tiring Ettie and that she is not in the mood for writing letters today. She ends her letter stating that she wanted to make sure that Ettie knew she received her clothes and the apple Ettie sent her will be made into a "clove apple of it if I can and keep it to remember your home by. Give my love to your mother." Emma adds a postscript writing: "I'd like it if some muse would come and tell me what to say but well I know he never will."

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3. Emma is Emma J. Thayer, a friend of Juliaette's that lives in Shopiere, Wisconsin. Emma is listed in the 1860 and 1870 US Census for Janesville, Rock Co., Wisconsin. She was born in 1852 or 1853. She would be the same age as Juliette A. E. Flagler who was born 15 June 1853.

4. *1872 4 9 Letr. Emma Thayer to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 061*; *1873 12 3 Letr. Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 62*; *1874 9 16 Letter - 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 078*; *1875 2 22 Letr. Emma J. Thayer 'E.J.F.' to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 095*; *1875 3 14 Letr. 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 099*; and *1874 9 20 - Letter - Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 536; 1876 9 8 Letter -- Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 132; and 1879 5 3 Letter - Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 186*. All of these letters share the same syntax and narrative style.

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